MTCA Board Summary

Partnership request and SWOT analysis

PURPOSE

To ask the MTCA board to **endorse and partner** with the Youth Race Council on **The Wolf of McKenzie Towne**, a youth-led adventure race planned for **late August 2027**, through six low-effort commitments. **No cash is requested from MTCA.**

THE PROJECT IN BRIEF

- **What:** an Amazing Race-style evening for teens aged 13–18, in clans of four. Every station is staged in a McKenzie Towne park whose playground theme matches the challenge, and the evening ends with a dusk finale where neighbours switch on their porch lights.
- **Who leads:** a Youth Race Council of 8–14 teens, including the President and VP of a local 4-H club, supported by screened adults and, from January, college marketing and theatre students on work-experience placements.
- **Goals:** build community, build neighbour relationships, and build youth leadership.
- **Partners being approached:** MTCA, the McKenzie Towne Council (HOA), the City of Calgary, local businesses, colleges and funders. Matching cash for government grants is being sought from the McKenzie Towne Council, not MTCA.
- **Estimated budget:** $3,400–$6,500, funded through grants, sponsors and registration fees, with bursaries so no teen is left out.

THE REQUEST

#	The ask	What MTCA actually does	Effort
1	**Introduce our youth to MTCA's City of Calgary neighbourhood contact**	One email introduction. The youth arrange and lead the meeting.	Very low
2	**Be the named applicant or partner on grants that need a registered non-profit**	Sign, and let the money pass through MTCA's account. **We write every application and report.**	Low
3	**Host college work-experience placements**	Named host on the placement agreement. **We supervise the students.**	Low
4	**Run one station on race day**	Two adult volunteers alongside our teen captain. **We supply props, script and training.**	One evening
5	**A letter of support**	Sign a one-page letter we draft	Very low
6	**Share our recruitment posts**	Repost in MTCA's newsletter or social media	Very low

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SWOT ANALYSIS: THE CASE FOR MTCA'S SUPPORT

STRENGTHS

- **Ready to go:** the story, course, safety plan, budget, planning workbook and invitation materials already exist
- **Youth-led with experienced leaders:** 4-H officers on the core team bring meeting, speaking and service experience
- **Built on our own parks:** the challenges use McKenzie Towne's themed playgrounds and village design
- **Safety designed in:** screened adults, the two-adult rule, coned chase zones, walk-only streets, no pond access
- **Low-effort asks:** each one is a signature, an introduction or one evening

WEAKNESSES (AND HOW MTCA'S SUPPORT HELPS)

- **A first-year event with no track record.** MTCA's endorsement provides the credibility funders look for
- **The youth group isn't a legal entity.** That's exactly why a community-association partner unlocks grants
- **Funding not yet secured.** Several grants favour community associations, so MTCA's name improves the odds
- **Relies on volunteers.** College placements and summer student jobs add trained help

OPPORTUNITIES FOR MTCA

- **Reach teens and young families**, an age group community associations often struggle to engage
- **Grow membership and volunteers** through recruitment and visibility on race day
- **Strengthen the City relationship** by connecting youth with MTCA's neighbourhood contact
- **New partnerships** with MRU, SAIT, U of C and local businesses
- **Brand visibility:** an MTCA-named station and recognition at the finale
- **A lasting annual tradition** that MTCA helped start

THREATS, AND HOW THEY'RE MANAGED

- **Tight grant deadlines.** Our team writes every application; MTCA only signs
- **Weather.** An indoor backup plan, with a lightning or hail call
- **Liability perception.** MTCA doesn't run the event; insurance is arranged separately
- **Volunteer burnout.** Clear roles, short shifts and student support
- **Reputation risk.** A youth-safety plan and vetted adults protect everyone, including MTCA

Bottom line: the strengths and opportunities sit with MTCA, and the effort, risk and cost sit with the organizing team. MTCA's partnership turns the project's main weaknesses (no legal entity, no track record, unsecured funding) into strengths.

WHAT MTCA RECEIVES

Recognition as a **Community Partner** on posters, the comic, social media and the finale stage • an **MTCA-named station** • a short **impact report** for MTCA's records and grant history • first invitation to **co-host Season Two**.

SUGGESTED MOTION

FOR THE BOARD'S CONSIDERATION

*"That the McKenzie Towne Community Association endorse **The Wolf of McKenzie Towne** youth event and authorize the board to: (1) introduce the Youth Race Council to MTCA's City of Calgary neighbourhood contact; (2) act as named applicant or partner on grants approved by the board, with all applications and reports prepared by the organizing team; (3) serve as host organization for college work-experience placements, with supervision provided by the organizing team; (4) staff one race-day station with two volunteers; (5) provide a letter of support; and (6) share event communications through MTCA channels. No MTCA funds are committed by this motion."*

Each grant application would come to the board, or a designated director, for signature before submission. MTCA keeps full control over what is signed in its name.